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TABLE I
The Indian Tradition of Counting

	Tens	Units
10	{Present; (degree 1)}	{Absent}
37	{Present; (degree 3)}	{Present; (degree 7)}

but these are linked to their following numbers with prefix 'one less,' as in Sanskrit which says 19 as one less 20, 29 as one less 30 and so on.

In the like manner, we call 90

TABLE II
The Roman Tradition of Counting

3 rd = III	8 th = VIII	38 th = XXXVIII	Ten less 50 th = XL
One less 5 th = IV	One less 10 th = IX	One less 40 th = XXXIX	50 th = L

TABLE III
The Binary Table of Counting

IDS	BS
0	0
1	1
2	10
3	11
4	100

that the digit representing unit's is absent. In other words, the new number is '10.' See Table I for Indian tradition of counting

When we peruse the IDS deeply and try to further probe it, it begins to look strange, complicated and tedious. But, thanks to our prolonged association with it, we think of it as natural as the art of walking erect.

RS. The second most ancient and popular system is the way in which the Romans counted. In the Roman system (RS), no special figures are written to represent the numbers. Instead, seven letter codes are used for indicating them; both individually and in association. These are:

I, V, X, L, C, D and M.

(Hint to remember: I Visit eXhibition Later Coming December Month.)

Although these numbers represent 1, 5, 10, 50, 100, 500 and 1000, the in-between numbers are written by jugglery only. Of course, it is the only counting system which has no zero in it. Secondly, 4, 9, 14, 19, 40, 90, etc are not called as fourth, ninth and so on

as 10 less 100.

Comments:

1. The alphabetical order is not maintained in this system—it is not C, D, I, L, M, V and X—albeit there is some order in which the progressive numbers are represented

2. There is no law suggesting that the length of the coded letters corresponds to the value of that number

As you can see in Table II, the number '50' is represented just by one letter (L), whereas 38, which is less than 50, uses a bigger letter-code (XXXVIII). The length of one number gets unmanageably large but shrinks abruptly for another number higher to it

You may ask "why should the length of a number correspond and be proportional to its weight?" It is quite logical to expect so. It has been the convention one is accustomed to—"big number, bigger digit" and "small number, smaller digit"—because it is so in the IDS, which has pre-laid all the standards for a counting system.

A couple of rules governing the RS are easy enough. The main drawback, however, is that it is not suitable for carrying out mathematical operations for obvious reasons.

BS. The BS system has some historical association dating back to

The names for the single-digit figures of the HdS are borrowed from Sanskrit ending with alphabet 'h'—suggestive of hexadecimal counting. For digits greater than '2,' German names are given.